

Aussie Primary Academy | Australian Curriculum v9.0 | Learn, Analyse and Practise

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	analyse and vary language as formality and social distance increase
KEY IDEA	Register changes with audience, purpose, role and relationship. Formal language often uses titles, precise vocabulary, complete forms and respectful modality; informal language may use contractions, idioms and shared references.
WORKED MODEL	Friend: Can you send the details? Community leader: Could you please provide the event details by Thursday? The request is unchanged, but the second version signals greater social distance.

SUCCESS CRITERIA - I CAN

[] identify register [] adapt language for an audience [] justify choices using evidence

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

1. Label formal, neutral or informal: (a) Hang on a sec. (b) Visitors are requested to sign in. (c) The meeting starts at noon.

2. Underline two choices that create formality: Dear Committee Members, I would appreciate your consideration of this proposal.

3. Explain why 'You must fix this now' may be unsuitable in an email to a community volunteer.

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

4. Rewrite for a principal: We can't do the trip 'cause the bus costs heaps.

5. Rewrite this formal sentence for a close teammate: I regret that I am unavailable to attend training.

6. Rank three requests from least to most socially distant and justify your ranking: Give me the form. / Could I please have the form? / We would be grateful if the completed form could be provided.

C. INDEPENDENT FLUENCY - CHECK AND CREATE

7. Write the same reminder for a class group chat and a school newsletter. Annotate two register changes.

8. Check one response: circle its greeting, modality, vocabulary and closing; improve any choice that does not suit the audience.

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D. APPLY THE SKILL IN CONTEXT

9. A student wants a shaded lunch area. Draft a 60-word email to the principal using an appropriate level of formality.

10. Convert the email into a 25-word message for a friend without changing the core request.

11. Compare both versions. Cite three exact language choices that reveal different roles or relationships.

E. REASON, EVALUATE AND TRANSFER

12. A public notice says, 'You guys better quit leaving your junk here.' Evaluate its likely effect and rewrite it for families.

13. Create a register ladder: express one request in informal, neutral and highly formal language. Explain when each version would be effective.

F. STUDENT REVIEW - PROVE YOUR UNDERSTANDING

[] I can adjust register as formality and social distance change.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

Evidence from my work that proves I understand: _____

The most difficult decision was _____ because _____

One correction or improvement I made: _____

My next practice step: _____

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Accept equivalent responses when the student applies the targeted skill accurately and justifies the choice.

COMPLETE ANSWER KEY

1. informal; formal; neutral.

2. 'Dear Committee Members' and 'I would appreciate your consideration' (also precise noun 'proposal').

3. It is direct and commanding; the role and voluntary relationship call for respectful modality and explanation.

4. Example: We are unable to proceed with the excursion because the transport cost is too high.

5. Example: Sorry, I can't make training.

6. Give me...; Could I please...; We would be grateful... Evidence should mention command, modal question and impersonal passive form.

7-8. Responses vary; meaning must stay stable while register choices suit each audience.

9-11. Check respectful greeting, clear request/reason, measured modality, concise friend version and evidence-based comparison.

12. It may sound accusatory and exclude readers. Example: Please place all rubbish in the labelled bins to help keep this shared area clean.

13. Accept three clearly differentiated versions with a plausible context for each.

TEACHER CHECK AND NEXT STEP

[] Identifies how language signals relationship and role.

[] Adapts register without changing the core meaning.

Next step: contrast two authentic audiences and require evidence from exact words.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION / WATCH OUT

Formal does not mean longer or full of difficult words; it means appropriate, precise and respectful.

Do not teach informal language as incorrect. Its effectiveness depends on context.

EXTENSION AND RE-TEACH

Re-teach: model one item aloud, complete one together, then ask the student to explain an independent correction.

Extension: transfer the skill to a short authentic text and justify two deliberate language choices with quoted evidence.